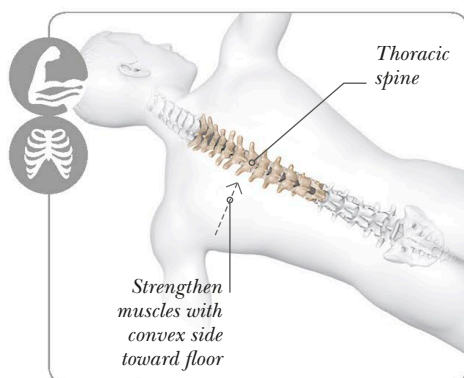
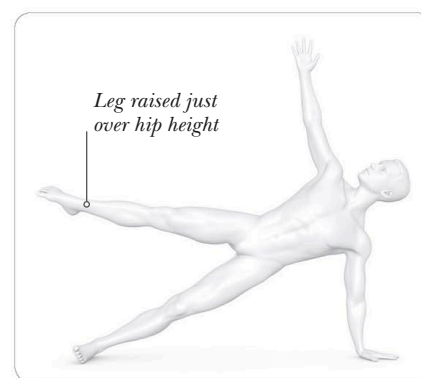




Scoliosis

In scoliosis the spine curves to the side making an S or, more commonly, a backward S shape. Some evidence suggests that strengthening the convex side of the primary curve with Side Plank—by practicing with the convex side toward the floor—can reduce sideways spinal curvature and symptoms. Consult a specialist if you are unsure which side needs strengthening more.



VARIATION

To further challenge your stability and strengthen your core muscles, slowly lift your top leg to a little over hip height. Keep your hips aligned and if you feel unstable lower your leg back down.

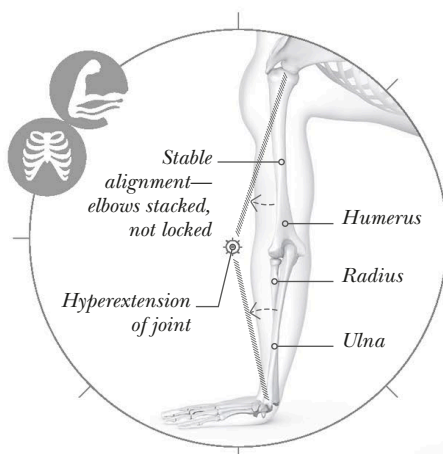
Back muscles engage more on this side of your spine

This side of your hip engages less than the supporting side

Knees extended but not locked

Feet are flexed (in dorsiflexion)

Calf muscles are in a lengthened position



Locking elbows

Avoid locking your elbows into hyperextension (>180 degrees). This causes compression on the weight-bearing joint. When the bones aren't stacked optimally, the uneven load may lead to osteoarthritis and impaired function over time. Instead, microbend your elbow so it appears straight and stacked. This will require more muscular effort but will bring long-term stability.

POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW